01. DECEMBER

The Elf Moves In

On the first of December, someone new suddenly appeared. Beside the little door stood a tiny suitcase. Next to it sat an elf in a red hat, puffing out his cheeks with exhaustion. “Made it!” he said. “My new home!” He opened the suitcase. First he pulled out a scarf. Then a brush. Then three pairs of socks, a cup, a pillow, and a much-too-long nightcap. The little space in front of his door got fuller and fuller. “Um,” the elf muttered. “It all looked much smaller inside my suitcase.” He pushed the socks under the pillow. He put the brush in the cup. He wrapped the scarf around the suitcase. But the long nightcap simply would not fit anywhere. Then the elf had an idea. He hung the nightcap over his little door like a flag. Then he put the suitcase beside it, sat down on top, and admired his new home. “Perfect,” he said happily. At that moment, the suitcase popped open again. Pop! Three socks flew out and landed on his head. The elf grinned. “Almost perfect.”

